Jose J. Alcocer

October 2026

GitHub | Google Scholar | LinkedIn | Personal Website

Contact Information

Langdell Hall, Harvard Law School
1585 Massachusetts Avenue,
Cambridge, MA 02138, USA

jalcocer@law.harvard.edu
alcocer@usc.edu

Appointments

Harvard University
Applied Research Statistician, Harvard Law School 2025 –

Stanford University
Research Analyst, Stanford Graduate School of Business 2025 – 2026

The Center for Election Science
Computational Social Scientist, Applied Data and Research 2024 – 2025

U.S. Census Bureau
Survey Statistician, Federal Statistical Research Data Center 2022 – 2025

Education

University of Southern California
Ph.D. in Political Science and International Relations, 2025
Committee: Christian R. Grose (Chair), Jeb Barnes, Pablo Barberá, Nicolas Duquette

Master of Public Policy, 2019

California State University, Long Beach
B.A., Political Science, 2017

Expertise

Substantive: American Politics, Mexican Politics, Elite Behavior, Political Institutions, Legislative Politics, U.S. Congress, Race and Ethnicity, Electoral Reform, Election Law, Bureaucratic Politics and Policing, Public Policy Analysis

Methodological: Multivariate Statistics, Maximum Likelihood Estimation, Causal Inference, Survey Design and Inference, Experimental Methods, NLP, LLM-Based Measurement, Computational Social Science

Peer-Reviewed Publications

5. "Police as Policymakers: How experiences with policy implementation shape policy representation," with Michael Sierra-Arévalo, Lauren Brown, Raquel Delerme, Benjamin A.T. Graham, Harry G. Muttram, Jackson Trager, and Nicholas Weller. (2026). *Political Research Quarterly*, OnlineFirst.

4. "The Subjectivity of Respect in Police Traffic Stops: Modeling Community Perspectives in Body-Worn Camera Footage," with Preni Golazizian, Elnaz Rahmati, Jackson Trager, Zhivar Sourati, Nona Ghazizadeh, Yiorgos Chochlakis, Kerby Bennett*, Aarya Vijay Devnani*, Parsa Hejabi*, Harry G. Muttram*, Akshay Kiran Padte*, Mehrshad Saadatinia*, Chenhao Wu*, Alireza S. Zaibari*, Michael Sierra-Arévalo, Nick Weller, Shrikanth Narayanan, Benjamin A.T. Graham, and Morteza Dehghani. (2026). In Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the *Association of Computational Linguistics* (Volume 1: Long Papers), ed. Maria Liakata, Viviane P. Moreira, Jiajun Zhang, and David Jurgens, 33939-33961. San Diego, CA: ACL.

3. "Legislator Responsiveness to Racialized Constituencies in Mexico," with José E. Múzquiz. (2025). *Journal of Experimental Political Science*, pp. 1-13.

2. "Minority Legislators Sponsor and Cosponsor Differently from Whites: Causal Evidence from U.S. Congress." (2025). *Journal of Race, Ethnicity, and Politics*, 10(2), pp. 277-289.

1. "Exploring the Effect of Colorado's Recreational Marijuana Policy on Opioid Overdose Rates." (2020). *Public Health*, 185, pp. 8-14.

Other Publications

10. "The California Elections and Policy Poll (CEPP) of the CA-11 U.S. House, Poll Conducted October 16-19," with Christian R. Grose, Alexander Wong, Mateo Schehtman, and Christina You. (2026). USC Democracy and Fair Elections Lab.

9. "The California Elections and Policy Poll (CEPP) of the California Primary, Poll Conducted May 23-26," with Matthew Mendez Garcia, Christian R. Grose, Raquel Centeno, Jarred Cuellar, and Alexander Wong. (2026). CSU Long Beach Center for Urban Politics and Policy and USC Democracy and Fair Elections Lab.

8. "What Does the USC Formula from the Cancelled Governor's Debate Teach Us? Candidate Viability Scores Predict Primary Vote Shares in California," with Christian R. Grose. (2026). *3Streams.* Medium.

7. "2025 State of Latino Entrepreneurship," with Rosalía Chávez Zárate, Marlene Orozco, and George Foster. (2026). *Stanford Latino Entrepreneurship Initiative.* Stanford Graduate School of Business.

6. "The Methodological Landscape With Respect to Identifying Gerrymandering." (2025). *Amicus Libris.* Briefs from the Harvard Law School Library.

5. "Facing Institutional Barriers to Sponsoring Bills in Congress, Newly Elected Minority Representatives Cosponsor Far More Than Their Non-Minority Counterparts." (2025). *United States Politics and Policy* (USAPP). London School of Economics Phelan United States Centre.

4. "Transforming the Vote: How Voting Reforms Can Improve Equity for Underrepresented Minorities," with Whitney Hua. (2024). The Center for Election Science. Last Updated January 2025.

3. "The California Elections and Policy Poll (CEPP) of the California Electorate, Poll Conducted September 12-25," with Christian R. Grose, Matthew Mendez Garcia, Raquel Centeno, Jarred Cuellar, Matt Lesenyie, Aloe Villagrana, and Alexander Wong. (2024). USC Democracy and Fair Elections Lab and CSU Long Beach Center for Urban Politics and Policy.

2. "The California Elections and Policy Polls (CEPP) of California's Competitive U.S. House Districts, Polls Conducted September 14-21," with Christian R. Grose, Matthew Mendez Garcia, Raquel Centeno, Jarred Cuellar, and Matt Lesenyie. (2024). USC Democracy and Fair Elections Lab and CSU Long Beach Center for Urban Politics and Policy.

1. "America [Mis]Represented: 2022 Vote-Split Elections Report," with Whitney Hua and Mike Piel. (2024). The Center for Election Science.

Software

7. `fathom:` Qualitative Coding and Measurement with Local Language Models.

6. `sdid:` Updated synthetic difference-in-differences estimation and inference for R.

5. `deid-review:` R shiny app for transcript de-identification review.

4. `rustgd:` R package providing rust-powered native desktop viewer windows.

3. `TextVizStudio:` Python-based, no-code web platform for text-as-data methods.

2. `AppendIDs:` R package for merging cross-national datasets that use incompatible country-coding schemes (Gleditsch-Ward, Correlates of War, IFS).

1. `topicmodelCV:` R package for choosing the number of topics (k) in LDA topic models via 10-fold cross-validation.

Working Papers

"Constrained-Label Classification and Measurement with Local Large Language Models."

"A Multistep Framework Towards De-Identifying Police Traffic-Stop Transcripts." with Kerby Bennett, Ellie Graeden, Benjamin A.T. Graham, and Nicholas Weller.

"Political Control and Policing: When Do Police Comply with Police Reform?" with Harry G. Muttram, Lauren Brown, Benjamin A.T. Graham, Michael Sierra-Arévalo, and Nicholas Weller. Revised and Resubmitted at *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*.

"LLM-Driven Ontology Development for Cross-Domain Data Integration within Interdisciplinary Research," with Kerby Bennett, Ellie Graeden, Benjamin A.T. Graham, Harry G. Muttram, Michael Sierra-Arévalo, and Nicholas Weller.

"Heritage Without History: Indigenous Identity and Colonial Silence in Mexican Municipal Discourse," with Blanca E. Alonso, José E. Múzquiz, and Iskar J. Waluyo.

"Redistricting Redux and the Battle to Win the U.S. House in 2026," with Christian R. Grose, and Seth C. McKee. Under Review.

"Top-Two Open Primary Systems Increase Ideological Diversity in State Legislative Parties," with Christian R. Grose. Under Review.

"Mexican Home Style: Symbolic Versus Substantive Legislative Responsiveness to Racialized Constituencies," with José E. Múzquiz.

"Community-Informed AI Models for Police Accountability," with Benjamin A.T. Graham, Lauren Brown, Yiorgos Chochlakis, Morteza Dehghani, Raquel Delerme, Brittany Friedman, Ellie Graeden, Preni Golazizian, Rajat Hebbar, Parsa Hejabi, Aditya Kommineni, Harry G. Muttram, Shrikanth Narayanan, Mayagüez Salinas, Michael Sierra-Arévalo, Jackson Trager, and Nicholas Weller. Revised and Resubmitted at *Humanities & Social Sciences Communications* (Nature Portfolio).

"Institutional Constraints Shape Minority Agenda-Setting: Evidence From the U.S. House (1981 – 2022)."

Teaching Experience

University of Southern California

Instructor

Introduction to Python for Social Science, Spring 2023

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Ideology and Conflict, Spring 2023
Environmental Challenges, Fall 2022

University of California, Los Angeles

Instructor

Introduction to Statistical Programming in R, Summer 2022

Research Experience

University of Southern California

Research Associate — 2023 – 2025
Security and Political Economy Lab
Supervising Faculty: Benjamin A.T. Graham

Research Assistant — 2021 – 2022
Price School of Public Policy and Gould School of Law
Primary Investigators: Abby Wood and Pamela McCann

Research Associate — 2021 – 2025
Democracy and Fair Elections Lab
Supervising Faculty: Christian R. Grose

Research Associate — 2019 – 2020

Schaeffer Center for Health Policy and Economics
Supervising Faculty: Sarah Axeen

The City Project
Policy Analyst 2018 – 2019
Supervising Practitioner: Robert Garcia

Conferences and Workshop Participation

Conference Presentations

Pathways to Primary Election Reform (PPER): 2026
American Political Science Association (APSA): 2024, 2025
Society for Political Methodology (PolMeth): 2023, 2024
Election Science, Reform, and Administration (ESRA): 2024, 2026
European Political Science Association (EPSA): 2025
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA): 2023, 2024
SoCal Political Institutions and Political Economy Conference (SoCal PIPE): 2023, 2024, 2026
Southern Political Science Association (SPSA): 2023
Western Political Science Association (WPSA): 2023, 2024

Workshops

University of Oxford 2023
Department of Politics and International Relations
Spring School in Advanced Research Methods

Syracuse University 2022
Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs
Institute for Qualitative and Mixed Method Research

Grants, Awards, and Fellowships

University of Southern California

Political Science and International Relations Summer Research Award 2024
$3,500

Graduate Student Government Professional Development Fund Award 2024
$500

Graduate School Travel/Research Award 2024
$1,500

Political Science and International Relations Summer Research Award 2023
$4,500

Graduate School Summer Research and Writing Grant 2023
$2,000

Political Science and International Relations Summer Research Award 2022
$2,500

Graduate School Summer Research and Writing Grant 2022
$2,500

Political Science and International Relations Summer Research Award 2021
$2,500

Graduate Diversity Scholarship and Tuition Fellowship Award 2020
$40,000/yr

Professional Skills

Programming and Scripting Languages: C++, JavaScript, Mata (Stata), Python, R, Rust, SQL

Markup and Styling: CSS, HTML, LaTeX

Web Applications: Google Suite, Infogram, Microsoft 365, Overleaf, Qualtrics